

Haydar Thaeer Abdo

Latakia, Syria || +963 934044938

Cyber Security | Junior Penetration Tester (Red Team) || Computer Engineering

Email: eng.haydar.abdo@gmail.com || LinkedIn: [linkedin.com/in/eng-haydar-abdo](https://www.linkedin.com/in/eng-haydar-abdo)

Github: <https://github.com/eng-haydar-abdo> || Portfolio: <https://eng-haydar-abdo.github.io/my-portfolio/>

SUMMARY:

Motivated Computer Engineering graduate and Cyber Security Penetration Tester with hands-on, methodology-driven experience across the full penetration testing lifecycle - from OSINT and reconnaissance through exploitation, privilege escalation, and reporting. Trained on Kali Linux and industry-standard tools (Nmap, Metasploit, Burp Suite, Hydra, Gobuster, Subfinder) against real vulnerable environments (Metasploitable 2, Windows 7, OWASP Juice Shop, CyberX) and hacking platforms (TryHackMe, PortSwigger Web Security Academy). Ranked 1st out of 25 trainees in an intensive, task-based Cyber Security training program, then promoted to Training Mentor, coaching 19 trainees across 31 sessions and driving an 80% improvement in their assessment performance through recon, enumeration, exploitation, and OWASP Top 10-aligned assessments. Strong foundation in networking, OOP, and problem solving, with additional full-stack and mobile development experience.

EDUCATION:

Latakia University – B.Sc. in Computer Engineering & Automatic Control (Graduated: 2026).

Academic Standing: **Ranked 3rd** in the academic cohort.

EXPERIENCE:

Cyber Security Training Mentor - Focal X Academy (Mar 2026 - Aug 2026)

- Transitioned from top-performing trainee to Teaching Assistant within Focal X Academy's intensive online Cyber Security & Penetration Testing program, leveraging a background in Red Teaming, offensive security, and web application penetration testing to guide and mentor 19 incoming trainees across 31 live sessions.
- Hands-on guidance: helped trainees master reconnaissance, enumeration, and exploitation concepts using Nmap, Subfinder, Maltego, and Gobuster.
- Lab & assessment guidance: coached learners through real-world hacking labs and tools including Metasploit, Burp Suite, SQLmap, and Hydra, aligned with the OWASP Top 10 framework.
- Platform facilitation: supported trainees in solving challenges on TryHackMe and the PortSwigger Web Security Academy.
- Actively reinforced a hands-on offensive-security learning environment, driving an 80% improvement in trainees' assessment performance while continuously sharpening skills in identifying, exploiting, and remediating complex security flaws.

Cyber Security Penetration Tester Trainee - Focal X Academy (Sep 2025 - Feb 2026)

- Completed a 4-month, intensive, task-based penetration testing program comprising 13 graded, timed assignments plus 2 full penetration testing engagements (CyberX, OWASP Juice Shop), finishing 1st out of 25 trainees.
- Applied the full penetration testing methodology: Information Gathering, Scanning & Enumeration, Vulnerability Assessment, Exploitation, Initial Access, Post-Exploitation, Privilege Escalation, Evidence Collection, and Reporting.
- Performed OSINT and reconnaissance using DNSdumpster, DNSLookup, Shodan, and Whois; applied 15+ industry-standard tools, including Nmap, Gobuster, Hydra, Subfinder, Netcraft, Metasploit, Msfvenom, Exploit-DB, NVD, crt.sh, and Burp Suite, across assessment phases.
- Conducted hands-on penetration testing across 4+ lab environments (Metasploitable 2, Windows 7 SP1 (x64), OWASP Juice Shop, and CyberX), with practical work on Linux and web application attack paths.
- CyberX lab: enumerated an Ubuntu 16.04 LTS environment, identifying 5+ services and vulnerabilities (ProFTPD 1.3.3c, OpenSSH 7.2p2, Apache 2.4.18, WordPress 4.9, MySQL) and local system users.
- CyberX exploitation: used Metasploit to exploit the ProFTPD 1.3.3c backdoor in the lab and obtain a Root session; also practiced WordPress-to-www-data access followed by local enumeration and privilege escalation analysis.

- Analyzed insecure file permissions and service/application versions in CyberX, correlating findings with known vulnerability information and documenting attack paths and evidence.
- Learned wordlist theory and application, including Kali Linux built-in wordlists and creation of custom, target-specific wordlists.
- Completed 25+ TryHackMe rooms and 33+ PortSwigger Web Security Academy labs, reinforcing OWASP Top 10-aligned exploitation skills.
- Used Wireshark, MalwareBytes, and VMware for traffic analysis, malware checks, and lab virtualization; used netstat and Task Manager to analyze processes and network connections.

Technical Skills:

- **Penetration Testing Methodology:** Information Gathering (Passive/Active), Scanning & Enumeration, Vulnerability Assessment, Exploitation, Post-Exploitation, Lateral Movement, Privilege Escalation, Evidence Collection, Reporting.
- **Tools:** Nmap, Gobuster, Hydra, Subfinder, Netcraft, Metasploit, Msfvenom, Burp Suite, Wireshark, MalwareBytes.
- **OSINT & Recon:** Shodan, Exploit-DB, NVD, Whois, DNSdumpster, DNSLookup, crt.sh, Maltego.
- **Practice Platforms / Labs:** OWASP Juice Shop, TryHackMe, PortSwigger Web Security Academy, Metasploitable 2, Windows 7 SP1 (x64), CyberX (Ubuntu 16.04 LTS).
- **Frameworks:** OWASP Top 10.
- **OS & Virtualization:** Kali Linux, VMware, Windows (netstat, Task Manager).
- **Networking & Fundamentals:** Networking basics, Wordlist theory & custom wordlist building, Problem Solving, OOP, Algorithms, Data Structures.
- **Programming:** C++, Python, Dart, Kotlin.

Front-end:

HTML5, CSS3, JavaScript, React, Bootstrap, REST APIs.

AI & Emerging Tools:

Proficient in utilizing multiple AI platforms (Chat-GPT, Claude, Google AI Studio, Copilot, Gemini, Black Box and AI-based code assistants) to enhance productivity, automate repetitive tasks, generate clean code, and improve problem-solving efficiency.

Soft Skills:

Time management, Collaboration, Patience, Ability to Work Under Pressure, Teamwork, Communication, Self-learning, Leadership, Multitasking, Adaptability.

Certificates:

- [Cyber Security](#) - Focal X Academy.
- Application Developer - Focal X Academy: Flutter [Lv.1](#), [Lv.2](#).
- Web Developer - Focal X Academy: [Lv.1](#).

Language:

- Arabic (Native)
- English (A2)